PassFrame
tuition

Writing Technique

Year 5 Accelerated — Homework ⏱ 45 min

Worked example — read this through before you start

Worked example: Identify the technique: "Twelve tiny tadpoles twisted through the tank."
Method & answer: Alliteration — the repeated 't' sound at the start of nearby words.

Easy / Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Which technique is used in "The moon watched silently over the sleeping city"? A) simile B) metaphor C) personification D) alliteration

2. Explain the difference between a simile and a metaphor, using one example of each.

3. Identify the technique: "Twelve tiny tadpoles twisted through the tank."

4. Which sentence uses a simile rather than a metaphor? A) The night sky was a black velvet cloak. B) The night sky looked like black velvet. C) The night sky swallowed the stars. D) The night sky stretched endlessly.

5. Write a simile AND a metaphor to describe the same thing: a raging river.

6. What technique is used in "The fireworks crackled, whizzed and boomed overhead"? Explain its effect on the reader.

7. Identify the most powerful verb in this sentence and explain your choice: "She hurled the ball and sprinted for the finish line."

8. Which sentence is the clearest example of alliteration? A) Dangerous dragons danced dramatically. B) The dragon was dangerous and large. C) It danced around the cave. D) The creature moved quickly.

9. Select ALL the sentences that use personification: A) The mountains stood guard over the valley. B) The mountains were tall and rocky. C) Winter crept in with icy fingers. D) The weather grew colder.

10. Choose the better-written sentence and explain why, referring to technique: A) "The explosion was loud and sudden." B) "The explosion tore through the silence, hurling debris into the smoke-choked sky."

11. Identify the technique and explain its effect: "The chains rattled and clanked in the darkness."

12. Write a metaphor describing a stubborn mule of a person, then explain what it suggests about their character.

13. Which sentence opens with a fronted adverbial to create variety? A) Within seconds, chaos erupted. B) Chaos erupted within seconds. C) Chaos erupted and it was sudden. D) It erupted, chaos, within seconds.

14. Identify the technique used in this sentence, and explain why a writer might choose it over a plain description: "Jealousy clawed at her chest."

15. Select ALL the phrases below that use a powerful, precise verb rather than a plain, overused one: A) crept silently B) went quietly C) hurtled forwards D) moved forwards

Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Explain the difference between

6. Select ALL the sentences below

11. Identify TWO techniques

personification and an extended metaphor.

2. Which sentence contains an example of pathetic fallacy? A) The sun shone on the joyful wedding. B) Dark clouds gathered as his mood darkened. C) It was cloudy and cold that day. D) The weather forecast predicted rain.

3. Identify the technique and explain its effect on the reader: "Doubt whispered in the back of his mind."

4. Rewrite this flat sentence using a powerful verb and sensory detail: "The woman walked into the kitchen and made tea."

5. Which sentence shows, rather than tells, that a character is furious, using more than one technique? A) Jack was furious about the decision. B) Jack felt very angry. C) Jack's fists clenched like coiled springs as his jaw tightened. D) Jack was cross and upset.

that combine TWO techniques in one sentence: A) The fire roared like a wild animal. B) The fire was hot. C) The frost bit and nipped at exposed skin. D) The frost was cold.

7. Write a sentence that uses personification to describe a deadline approaching, creating a sense of pressure.

8. Which technique is used in "She sells sea-shells on the sea-shore"? A) alliteration and repetition B) simile and metaphor C) onomatopoeia and personification D) repetition and onomatopoeia

9. Explain why opening a paragraph with a short, sharp sentence ("Silence.") can be more effective than a longer descriptive sentence in the right context.

10. Choose the better-written sentence and explain why, using technical vocabulary: A) "The battlefield was quiet and sad afterwards." B) "An eerie stillness settled over the battlefield, its silence heavier than any gunfire."

combined in this sentence and explain their combined effect: "The wind screamed and tore at the tent like a wild animal fighting to get in."

12. Which sentence uses a fronted adverbial phrase (not a single adverb) to open? A) In the blink of an eye, everything changed. B) Suddenly, everything changed. C) Everything changed suddenly. D) It changed.

13. Select ALL the sentences below that use varied, non-subject-first openers: A) High above the clouds, the plane soared. B) The plane soared high above the clouds. C) Exhausted, she collapsed onto the sofa. D) She collapsed onto the sofa, exhausted.

14. Write a sentence that 'shows' a character feeling defeated, using a powerful verb and one other technique.

15. Identify the technique and explain why the writer chose it over a literal description: "The deadline loomed over her like a storm cloud, ready to burst."

Standard / Advanced — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. What is "pathetic fallacy" and how does it differ from personification more generally? Give an example.

2. Which sentence best demonstrates an extended metaphor comparing a difficult friendship to a stormy sea? A) Their friendship was difficult sometimes.

6. Select ALL the techniques used in this sentence: "Anger burned in his chest like a furnace, and his words came out scorched with rage." A) simile B) personification C) metaphor D) onomatopoeia

7. Identify the technique and explain why it is a particularly sophisticated choice here: "Time was a thief, stealing her childhood one day at a time."

11. Select ALL the sentences below that use a powerful verb to imply character or emotion, not just action: A) He hurled his bag across the room. B) He put his bag down. C) She murmured her apology. D) She said her apology.

12. Identify the technique used in "Loneliness settled over him like an old, familiar coat" and explain its layered effect.

B) Their friendship was like a stormy sea, calm one moment and capsizing the next. C) They had ups and downs in their friendship. D) Their friendship was stormy.

3. Explain the effect of the powerful verb "wrestled" in: "She wrestled the stubborn zip closed."

8. Which sentence demonstrates the most sophisticated sentence variety? A) She was tired. She sat down. She closed her eyes. B) Exhausted, she sank into the chair and let her eyes drift shut. C) She was tired, so she sat down and closed her eyes. D) Because she was tired, she sat down and then she closed her eyes.

13. Which sentence uses onomatopoeia alongside personification to build atmosphere? A) The shutters banged and rattled, protesting the wind. B) The shutters were loose and old. C) He heard the shutters. D) The shutters needed fixing.

4. Rewrite this flat, 'telling' paragraph opener using at least two techniques: "It was a busy morning. The station was crowded."

9. Explain why writers sometimes deliberately break sentence-length convention (e.g. using a one-word sentence like "Nothing.") for effect.

14. Explain why combining alliteration, a powerful verb and personification makes this sentence particularly effective: "The bitter blizzard battered the stranded travellers without mercy."

5. Which of these two extracts is more sophisticated, and why? A) "The forest was dark and there were strange noises." B) "Shadows pooled between the trees like spilled ink, and the forest held its breath around every unexplained sound."

10. Write a short extended metaphor (two to three sentences) comparing hope to a small flame, and annotate it by labelling the technique used in each sentence.

15. Choose the more skilfully written paragraph opener and explain why, using at least three technical terms: A) "It was a stormy night. The waves were big. The boat rocked around." B) "The storm hurled the boat about like a toy, waves rearing like wild horses against the groaning hull."